



The Body Temple Spa
ATHENS · SKIN LONGEVITY

CLIENT RECOMMENDATION GUIDE

Skin Tightening & *Firming*

Firmness is built, not bought. This guide walks through the professional treatments, training, nutrition, recovery and skincare that work together to improve the look of skin laxity — and is honest about what each one can and cannot do.

SECTIONS

Eight

APPROACH

Treatment + Lifestyle

PREPARED FOR

Our Guests

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What Actually Shapes Skin Firmness

Skin firmness is influenced by collagen and elastin, muscle mass, nutrition, hydration, sleep, age, hormones, genetics, sun exposure, and changes in body weight.

The best results may come from combining appropriate professional treatments with consistent skincare, strength training, adequate protein, and quality recovery. No single item in this guide is a stand-alone answer — the combination is the strategy.

PLEASE READ FIRST

Results vary. **No treatment, product, supplement, behavior, probiotic, or peptide can guarantee that loose skin will completely tighten.** This guide is educational and does not replace individualized medical or nutritional advice.

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1 Professional Skin-Tightening Treatments

Radiofrequency Skin Tightening

Radiofrequency uses controlled energy to heat targeted tissue. This may stimulate collagen and elastin remodeling, helping improve the appearance of mild skin laxity, texture, and firmness.

Results develop gradually and usually require a series of treatments.

Laser Skin Tightening

Laser skin tightening delivers controlled light-based energy into targeted layers of the skin. The heat may stimulate collagen remodeling and gradually improve firmness, texture, fine lines, and mild skin laxity.

The appropriate laser and treatment intensity depend on your skin tone, medical history, treatment area, and desired results. Laser procedures must be performed by a properly licensed and trained professional within their legal scope of practice.

AT-HOME OPTION

You can also do at-home treatments in as little as two minutes per day with [this device](#). More impactful treatment will always require a professional.

Red Light Therapy

Red light therapy, also called photobiomodulation, exposes the skin to specific wavelengths of red or near-infrared light. It may support cellular activity, circulation, inflammation management, and the skin's natural repair processes. With consistent use, it may help improve the appearance of skin texture, fine lines, and firmness.

Red light therapy is generally used as a **supportive** treatment. Results depend on the wavelength, strength of the device, treatment duration, frequency, and consistency.

Clients taking light-sensitive medications or living with a photosensitive condition should consult a qualified healthcare professional before treatment.

SECTION ONE, CONTINUED

Microchanneling or Microneedling

These procedures create controlled micro-injuries that activate the skin's natural repair response. They may encourage collagen production and improve texture, fine lines, acne scars, and mild skin laxity.

Treatment eligibility depends on your skin condition, medical history, treatment area, and applicable licensing requirements.

PERSONALIZED TREATMENT SERIES

Collagen remodeling takes time. A customized treatment series may provide better results than a single appointment. The number and frequency of treatments should be based on your skin condition, treatment area, selected technology, goals, and response.

2 Strength Training

What appears to be loose skin may sometimes be partly related to reduced muscle mass or muscle tone beneath the skin.

When the underlying muscles lose volume, an area can appear softer, less defined, or less firm. Strength training helps build and preserve muscle, which may improve the shape, firmness, and overall appearance of the targeted area.

SET THE EXPECTATION HONESTLY

Strength training **cannot remove significant excess skin**. Results depend on the amount of skin laxity, age, genetics, weight changes, nutrition, exercise consistency, and overall health.

WHAT IT CAN DO

- Build and preserve muscle volume
- Improve shape and definition of an area
- Support the skin from underneath
- Protect muscle during weight loss

WHAT IT CANNOT DO

- Remove significant excess skin
- Replace a professional treatment plan
- Work without adequate protein
- Produce results without consistency

PAIR IT WITH THE REST OF THE PLAN

Training is most effective alongside sufficient protein (Section 3), real recovery (Section 4), and an appropriate professional treatment series (Section 1). Treat these as one plan rather than four separate projects.

3 Protein & Nutrition

Approximately 30 Grams of Protein per Meal

A practical goal is approximately 30 grams of protein at each main meal, adjusted for your body size, activity level, medical needs, and total daily protein goal.

Protein provides amino acids needed to build and preserve muscle and support normal tissue repair. Distributing protein throughout the day may make it easier to meet daily needs and support strength-training goals.

PROTEIN SOURCES MAY INCLUDE

- Chicken, turkey, lean beef, or fish
- Greek yogurt or cottage cheese, when tolerated
- Tofu or tempeh, when tolerated
- Lentils and beans
- Protein powder that meets your dietary needs
- Other individualized protein sources

Clients with kidney disease, liver disease, pregnancy, or another relevant medical condition should consult their healthcare provider before significantly increasing protein intake.

Collagen Peptides With Vitamin C

Hydrolyzed collagen peptides provide amino acids commonly found in connective tissue. Vitamin C is required for normal collagen synthesis, which is why collagen may be paired with a source of vitamin C. That vitamin C can come from food or an appropriate supplement.

Collagen supplements may modestly support skin hydration or elasticity for some people, but results vary. **Collagen is not a complete protein** and should not replace the complete protein needed for muscle development.

Vitamin C-Rich Foods

Supports normal collagen synthesis and acts as an antioxidant.

- Bell peppers
- Berries
- Broccoli
- Kiwi
- Citrus fruit
- Brussels sprouts

Healthy Fats

Support normal cellular function and absorption of fat-soluble vitamins.

- Olive oil
- Avocado
- Nuts
- Seeds
- Suitable fatty fish

Balanced Micronutrient Intake

Iron, zinc, copper, vitamin D, vitamin A, vitamin C, and other nutrients contribute to normal skin and tissue function. Supplements should be selected according to individual needs rather than assuming that higher doses will improve the skin.

SECTION THREE, CONTINUED

Gradual Weight Change

Rapid weight loss can make skin laxity more noticeable because the skin may not adapt as quickly as body volume changes. A gradual, medically appropriate approach to weight management may allow more time for tissue adaptation while helping preserve muscle.

Hydration, Kangen Water & Mineral Salts

Adequate hydration supports normal body functions and may help the skin appear less dry.

Drinking water does not independently tighten loose skin, but consistent hydration supports general wellness, exercise performance, circulation, and recovery.

Kangen Water

Kangen Water is a brand of electrically ionized alkaline water produced by an Enagic water-ionizing machine. It can be used as a hydration option if the water is potable and the machine is properly cleaned and maintained.

Alkaline water has not been proven to tighten skin, increase collagen, "detoxify" the body, or provide better hydration than safe drinking water for most people. The kidneys and lungs tightly regulate the body's internal pH, so alkaline water does not meaningfully alkalize the blood.

Clients with kidney disease, electrolyte abnormalities, or medications affected by mineral or electrolyte intake should consult a healthcare professional before routinely consuming strongly alkaline water.

IF YOU WOULD LIKE A MACHINE

You can purchase one [here](#), or contact us at hello@thebodytemplespas.com for payment options.

Himalayan or Celtic Sea Salt

A small amount of Himalayan pink salt or Celtic sea salt adds sodium and trace minerals to water. Sodium can support fluid balance when electrolytes have been lost through prolonged exercise, heavy sweating, vomiting, diarrhea, or significant heat exposure.

However, these salts are **not complete electrolyte products** and are not necessary in every glass of water. They contain mostly sodium chloride, and their trace mineral content is too small to treat a mineral deficiency or tighten the skin.

Use either Himalayan salt or Celtic sea salt — not both together. Adding salt routinely may be inappropriate for clients with:

- High blood pressure
- Kidney or heart disease
- Fluid retention or swelling
- A sodium-restricted diet
- Certain medications or electrolyte disorders

4 Circadian Rhythm & Recovery

Consistent Sleep & Wake Times

Going to bed and waking up at approximately the same time each day helps reinforce your circadian rhythm. A consistent schedule may improve sleep quality, recovery, energy, and the ability to maintain healthy behaviors.

Sleep Duration

Most adults benefit from approximately seven to nine hours of sleep, although individual needs vary. Adequate sleep supports muscle recovery, appetite regulation, immune function, energy, and normal tissue repair.

Morning Light Exposure

Natural outdoor light shortly after waking helps signal daytime to the brain and supports your internal clock. Morning light may make it easier to feel alert during the day and appropriately sleepy at night.

Evening Light Reduction

Bright overhead lighting and excessive screen exposure at night may delay your body's natural nighttime signals. Lowering the lights and reducing stimulating screen use before bed may support better sleep.

Meal Timing

A consistent eating schedule can support circadian regularity. When possible, avoid very large meals immediately before bedtime if they interfere with sleep or digestion.

Exercise Timing

Exercise should be scheduled at a time that allows you to remain consistent and recover well. Intense late-night exercise may disturb sleep for some people, while others tolerate it without difficulty.

Stress Regulation

Chronic stress may interfere with sleep, nutrition, exercise consistency, and recovery. Supportive practices may include:

- Breathing exercises
- Prayer
- Meditation
- Journaling
- Gentle yoga
- Time outdoors
- Professional counseling when appropriate

RECOVERY COORDINATION

Professional treatments, strength training, sleep, hydration, and nutrition should be coordinated rather than treated as unrelated activities. Treatment and training schedules should allow appropriate recovery, particularly when the skin or muscles feel tender.

5 Topical Skin-Supporting Products

Broad-Spectrum Sunscreen

Daily broad-spectrum sunscreen helps protect the skin from ultraviolet damage that contributes to premature collagen breakdown, wrinkles, discoloration, and reduced elasticity.

Apply sunscreen to exposed skin and reapply according to the product's directions, particularly during prolonged outdoor exposure.

Retinol or Prescription Retinoid

Retinoids are vitamin A derivatives that support skin-cell turnover and collagen production. They may improve fine lines, uneven tone, and texture over time.

Begin gradually because retinoids can cause dryness, peeling, irritation, and increased sun sensitivity. Prescription-strength products require a medical provider.

Retinoids are generally avoided during pregnancy unless a qualified clinician provides different instructions.

Topical Peptide Serum or Moisturizer

Topical peptides are short chains of amino acids used in skincare products to support hydration, barrier function, and a firmer-looking appearance. Results depend on the formulation and consistent use. A topical peptide product should not be assumed to penetrate or work like an injectable medication.

Copper Peptide Skincare

Copper peptide products, commonly associated with GHK-Cu, are marketed to support the appearance of skin repair, texture, and firmness. Topical use has greater cosmetic relevance than injectable use, but results vary according to the formulation. Patch-test new products and stop using them if significant irritation develops.

One of the best-formulated products with known results is **EllieVate Skin + Topical Rejuvenating Serum** from EllieMD. You can create an account and purchase at elliemd.com/Thebodytemplespa to access partner prices.

Vitamin C Serum

A properly formulated topical vitamin C product may provide antioxidant support and improve the appearance of uneven tone. Vitamin C also participates in normal collagen synthesis. Some formulas may cause irritation, so gradual introduction and proper storage are important.

6 Oral Supplements & Probiotics

Hydrolyzed Collagen Peptides

Hydrolyzed collagen is broken into smaller peptides for easier mixing and digestion. Some studies suggest modest improvements in skin hydration or elasticity, but results are not guaranteed and product quality varies. Collagen should complement — not replace — complete dietary protein.

Vitamin C

Vitamin C is required for normal collagen synthesis. Clients who already consume sufficient vitamin C may not benefit from unnecessarily high supplemental doses. Large doses may cause digestive symptoms and may not be appropriate for everyone.

Protein Supplement

A protein powder may help you reach approximately 30 grams of protein per meal when food alone is inconvenient. The product should be selected according to your allergies, dietary preferences, ingredients, and medical needs.

Omega-3 Fatty Acids

Omega-3 fats support general cardiovascular and inflammatory health. They are not direct skin-tightening supplements. Anyone taking blood-thinning medication or preparing for a procedure should ask a healthcare professional whether supplementation is appropriate.

Lactobacillus reuteri Probiotic

According to *Super Gut* author Dr. William Davis, specific strains of *Lactobacillus reuteri* may stimulate oxytocin-related pathways associated with increased dermal collagen, improved skin thickness, fewer visible wrinkles, and muscle preservation. The two strains commonly used in his approach are:

- *L. reuteri* DSM 17938
- *L. reuteri* ATCC PTA 6475

These strains are available together in certain BioGaia Gastrus products. Probiotic effects are **strain-specific**, so a product containing a different *L. reuteri* strain should not automatically be expected to produce the same effects.

These proposed benefits are associated with Dr. Davis's approach and should not be presented as guaranteed or established skin-tightening outcomes. Human evidence remains limited. A probiotic should complement — not replace — adequate protein, strength training, skincare, professional treatments, and recovery.

People who are pregnant, immunocompromised, seriously ill, or living with a complex gastrointestinal condition should consult a healthcare professional before beginning a probiotic or concentrated fermented preparation.

SUPPLEMENT & PROBIOTIC SAFETY

Supplements and probiotics can interact with medications, health conditions, and procedures. Share your complete medication and supplement list with your healthcare provider. Third-party-tested products are preferred when available.

7 Injectable Peptides: Education

IMPORTANT MEDICAL NOTICE

Injectable peptides must be prescribed, dispensed, and monitored by a qualified healthcare professional when medically and legally appropriate. We can help you arrange and order 503A and FDA-approved peptides with EllieMD — create an account at elliemd.com/Thebodytemplespa to access partner prices.

This guide does **not** provide injection instructions, dosages, or self-administration directions; that must come from a doctor. If you use the link above to partner with EllieMD, we will provide a doctor for you.

Injectable GHK-Cu

GHK-Cu is a copper-binding peptide studied for its possible roles in tissue signaling, wound repair, and collagen-related processes. Topical copper-peptide skincare is different from injectable GHK-Cu.

Injectable GHK-Cu is not FDA-approved as a skin-tightening treatment. Human evidence for cosmetic injection is limited.

BPC-157

BPC-157 is marketed online for injury recovery, tissue repair, and inflammation. It is not FDA-approved, and reliable human safety and effectiveness data remain limited.

There is no established clinical evidence showing that BPC-157 tightens loose skin. Unapproved injectable products may introduce risks involving sterility, contamination, incorrect concentration, and immune reactions.

NOT RECOMMENDED AS A SKIN-TIGHTENING TREATMENT

TB-500

TB-500, a product associated with fragments of thymosin beta-4, is marketed for healing and physical recovery.

It is not an FDA-approved cosmetic skin-tightening medication, and adequate human evidence supporting this use is unavailable. Product identity, purity, sterility, and long-term effects may be uncertain when purchased from unregulated sources.

NOT RECOMMENDED AS A SKIN-TIGHTENING TREATMENT

SECTION SEVEN, CONTINUED

MOTS-c

MOTS-c is a mitochondrial-derived peptide being researched for its role in metabolic signaling. It is sometimes marketed for energy, exercise performance, or metabolic health.

It is not FDA-approved for skin tightening. Safety concerns may include potential immune reactions and risks related to peptide impurities or product quality.

EXPERIMENTAL · NOT RECOMMENDED FOR SKIN TIGHTENING

Injectable Peptide Safety Checklist

Before considering an injectable peptide, confirm every item below.

- ① A qualified medical provider has completed an evaluation.
- ② The peptide's FDA approval status is current and understood.
- ③ Expected benefits have been explained as possible — not guaranteed.
- ④ Risks, contraindications, and medication interactions have been reviewed.
- ⑤ Appropriate baseline and follow-up monitoring have been established.
- ⑥ The medication comes from a lawful, appropriately licensed source.
- ⑦ The product is **not** labeled "research use only."
- ⑧ Pregnancy, breastfeeding, cancer history, diabetes risk, hormone conditions, and other relevant conditions have been discussed.

THE SHORT VERSION

None of the injectable peptides in this section is an approved skin-tightening treatment. If a peptide is right for you for another medical reason, it belongs in a physician's hands — not in a self-administered protocol bought online.

8 Supportive Behaviors

These habits protect every result the rest of this guide is working toward.

Avoid Smoking and Nicotine

Smoking and nicotine exposure can negatively affect circulation, wound healing, and collagen health. Avoiding tobacco and nicotine supports general skin, cardiovascular, and respiratory health.

Limit Excessive Alcohol

Excessive alcohol may interfere with hydration, sleep, nutrition, exercise performance, and recovery. Alcohol should be limited or avoided according to your personal health needs.

Protect the Skin From Excessive Sun Exposure

Ultraviolet exposure contributes to premature collagen and elastin breakdown. Sunscreen, shade, protective clothing, and avoiding unnecessary tanning are important parts of a long-term firming plan.

Maintain a Stable Weight

Frequent or dramatic weight changes repeatedly alter tissue volume and may make skin laxity more noticeable. Maintaining a reasonably stable weight after reaching a goal may help preserve results.

Follow the Treatment Schedule

Skin remodeling is gradual. Completing the recommended treatment series and attending maintenance appointments may support more consistent results.

PUTTING IT TOGETHER

Your Firming Plan, *One Page*

1 Book a consultation and build the treatment series

We assess your skin, history, and goals, then recommend the technology and cadence that fit — radiofrequency, laser, red light, microchanneling, or a combination.

2 Train for strength two to four times a week

Build and preserve the muscle underneath the area you want to firm.

3 Anchor roughly 30 g of protein to every main meal

Add a vitamin C source, healthy fats, and steady hydration. Change weight gradually.

4 Protect sleep and recovery

Consistent sleep and wake times, morning light, dimmer evenings, seven to nine hours.

5 Keep the daily skincare simple and consistent

Broad-spectrum sunscreen every day, a retinoid as tolerated, peptides and vitamin C.

6 Run anything injectable through a physician

We can connect you with a provider through EllieMD.

READY WHEN YOU ARE

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